

Quantum Computing Fundamentals

From kets to key distribution

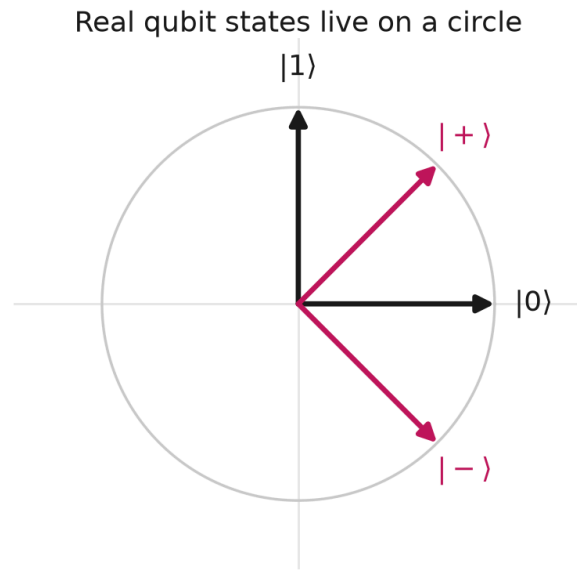
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Based on *Quantum Computing for Everyone* (Bernhardt), implemented in Qiskit

Everything here is 2D, and real

A qubit is a vector of length 1. With **real** amplitudes, every state sits on the unit circle. **Kets** are column vectors; **bras** are their transpose.

$$|0\rangle = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad |1\rangle = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \langle 0| = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$



Complex amplitudes would fill a sphere instead. Not needed until the quantum Fourier transform.

A qubit, and why the squares sum to 1

$$|v\rangle = c_0|0\rangle + c_1|1\rangle \quad c_0^2 + c_1^2 = 1$$

c_0 and c_1 are **probability amplitudes**. Measuring gives

$$P(0) = c_0^2 \quad P(1) = c_1^2$$

so the normalisation condition is just "the probabilities add to 1".

Standard basis — $\{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$ — is orthonormal:

$$\langle 0|0\rangle = 1 \quad \langle 1|1\rangle = 1 \quad \langle 0|1\rangle = 0$$

A bra times a ket gives a number: the overlap between two states.

Two qubits: the tensor product

Alice has $|v\rangle = c_0|a_0\rangle + c_1|a_1\rangle$, Bob has $|w\rangle = d_0|b_0\rangle + d_1|b_1\rangle$.

$$|v\rangle \otimes |w\rangle = c_0d_0|a_0b_0\rangle + c_0d_1|a_0b_1\rangle + c_1d_0|a_1b_0\rangle + c_1d_1|a_1b_1\rangle$$

Name the four amplitudes:

$$r = c_0d_0 \quad s = c_0d_1 \quad t = c_1d_0 \quad u = c_1d_1$$

It is still normalised, because

$$\underbrace{(c_0^2 + c_1^2)}_1 \underbrace{(d_0^2 + d_1^2)}_1 = r^2 + s^2 + t^2 + u^2 = 1$$

The entanglement test

If the state really came from a tensor product, then

$$ru = c_0 d_0 \cdot c_1 d_1 = c_0 c_1 d_0 d_1 \quad st = c_0 d_1 \cdot c_1 d_0 = c_0 c_1 d_0 d_1$$

They must be equal. So:

$$\begin{array}{l} ru = st \Rightarrow \text{separable} \\ ru \neq st \Rightarrow \text{entangled} \end{array}$$

Separable means each qubit has a state of its own. Entangled means only the **pair** has a state.

Equivalently: $ru - st$ is the determinant of $\begin{bmatrix} r & s \\ t & u \end{bmatrix}$, so separable = determinant zero.

Example A — not entangled

Alice $\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right)$, Bob $\left(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$. Tensor them:

$$r = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \quad s = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{2}} \quad t = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} \quad u = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{2}}$$

Test: $ru = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{8}$ and $st = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{8}$. Equal $\rightarrow$ separable.

Group by Alice's kets:

$$|a_0\rangle \left(\frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} |b_0\rangle + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{2}} |b_1\rangle \right) + |a_1\rangle \left(\frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}} |b_0\rangle + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2\sqrt{2}} |b_1\rangle \right)$$

Normalise each bracket — both have norm $\sqrt{\frac{1}{8} + \frac{3}{8}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$ — and Bob's part is a **common factor**:

$$= \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |a_0\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |a_1\rangle \right) \left(\frac{1}{2} |b_0\rangle + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} |b_1\rangle \right)$$

Example B — entangled

$$r = \frac{1}{2} \quad s = \frac{1}{2} \quad t = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \quad u = 0$$

Test: $ru = 0$ but $st = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{2}}$. Different $\rightarrow$ entangled.

Group by Alice's kets and normalise the same way:

$$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|a_0\rangle \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|b_0\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|b_1\rangle \right) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|a_1\rangle|b_0\rangle$$

Bob's two brackets are now **different**, so nothing factors out. Neither qubit has a state of its own.

What that means: Alice measures $|a_0\rangle$ or $|a_1\rangle$ with equal odds — but her result decides Bob's. Get $|a_1\rangle$ and Bob is $|b_0\rangle$ with certainty.

Single-qubit gates

$$I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad X = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad Y = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad Z = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad H = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

```
qc.h(0)    # superposition
qc.x(0)    # NOT: |0> <-> |1>
qc.z(0)    # flips the sign of |1>
qc.y(0)    # both at once
```



X is NOT. Z changes the **relative phase** without changing any probability.

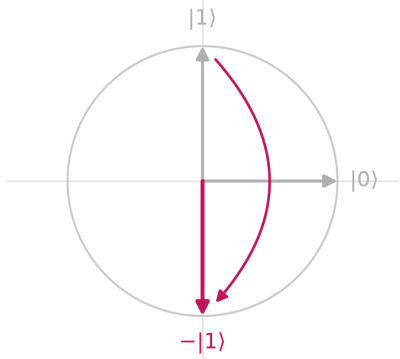
H puts a basis state into superposition: $H|0\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle + |1\rangle)$.

Y here is the real-valued version; the true Pauli Y carries a factor $-i$, and only that one squares to I .

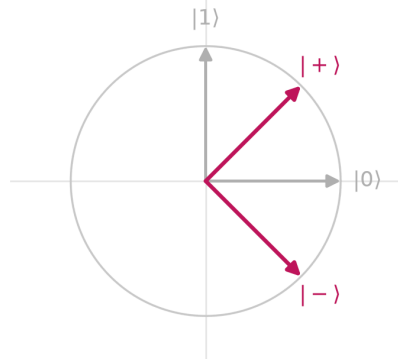
What each gate actually does

	on $ 0\rangle$	on $ 1\rangle$	in words
I	$ 0\rangle$	$ 1\rangle$	nothing
X	$ 1\rangle$	$ 0\rangle$	NOT — swaps the two
Z	$ 0\rangle$	$- 1\rangle$	flips the sign of $ 1\rangle$ only
H	$ +\rangle$	$ -\rangle$	into superposition

Z leaves $|0\rangle$, flips the sign of $|1\rangle$



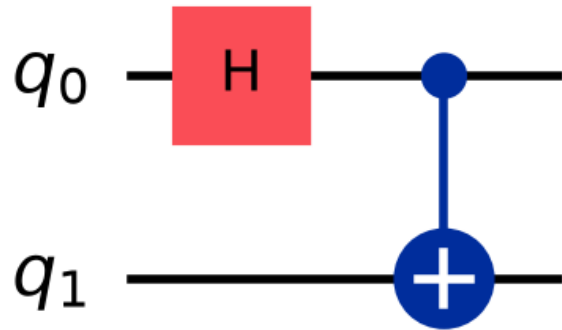
H sends $|0\rangle \rightarrow |+\rangle$ and $|1\rangle \rightarrow |-\rangle$



Z alone is invisible to measurement — but $HZH|0\rangle = |1\rangle$.

CNOT, and making entanglement

A single-qubit gate can **never** entangle. You need a two-qubit gate.

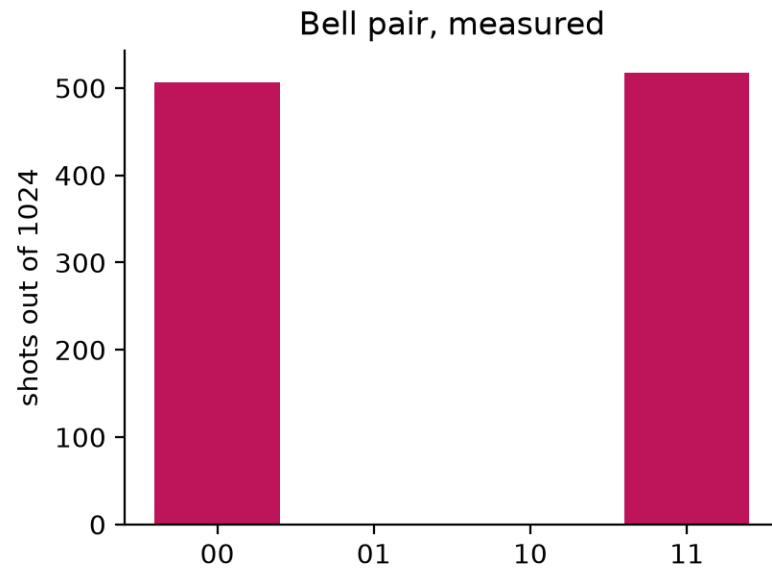


```
qc = QuantumCircuit(2)
qc.h(0)           # superposition
qc.cx(0, 1)       # entangle
```

$$|00\rangle \xrightarrow{H} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |10\rangle) \xrightarrow{CNOT} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle)$$

Test it: $r = u = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$, $s = t = 0$, so $ru = \frac{1}{2} \neq 0 = st$. **Entangled.**

And it shows up in the measurements



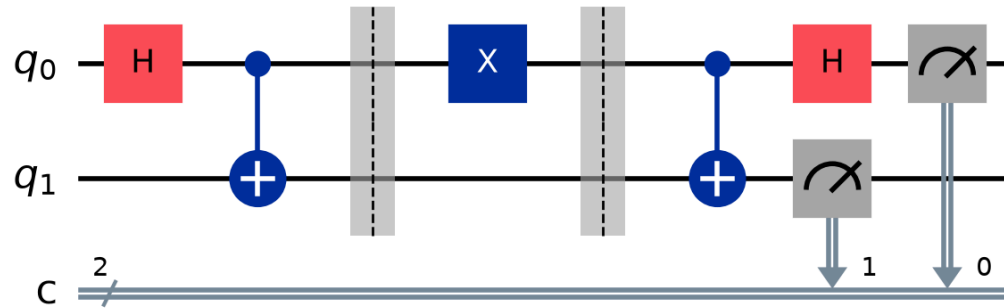
Only `00` and `11` . Never `01` or `10` .

The two qubits always agree — but neither had a value before measurement.

This **Bell pair** is the resource every protocol below is built on.

Superdense coding

Send **2 classical bits** by physically transmitting **1 qubit**.



Alice and Bob share $\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle)$. Alice applies one gate to **her qubit only**, sends it, and Bob undoes the Bell circuit.

bits	00	01	10	11
Alice applies	I	X	Z	ZX

Superdense coding — why it works

$$|00\rangle \xrightarrow{H} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |10\rangle) \xrightarrow{CNOT} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|00\rangle + |11\rangle)$$

Alice applies X to send `01`:

$$\xrightarrow{X} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|10\rangle + |01\rangle)$$

Bob reverses the Bell circuit:

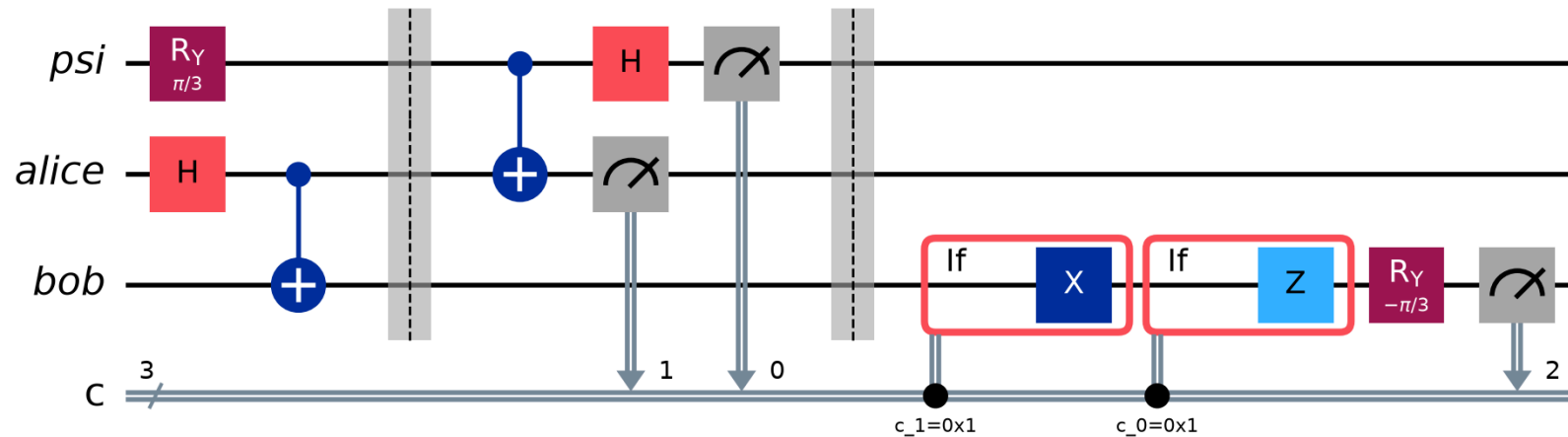
$$\xrightarrow{CNOT} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|11\rangle + |01\rangle) \xrightarrow{H} |01\rangle$$

```
qc.h(0); qc.cx(0, 1)    # Bell pair, shared in advance
qc.x(0)                 # Alice encodes "01" on her qubit alone
qc.cx(0, 1); qc.h(0)    # Bob decodes
```

The four gates map the pair onto four distinguishable Bell states. Entanglement is what lets one qubit carry two bits.

Quantum teleportation

Move **1 qubit's state** using **2 classical bits**. The exact opposite trade.



Alice entangles her unknown state with her half of the pair, measures both, and sends the two bits. Bob applies a correction.

Bob receives	00	01	10	11
Bob applies	I	X	Z	Y

Teleportation — the catch

The state is **not copied** — no-cloning forbids that. Alice's measurement destroys her copy at the moment Bob's appears.

Nothing travels faster than light either: without the 2 classical bits, Bob's qubit is useless. Each of his four possible states is equally likely.

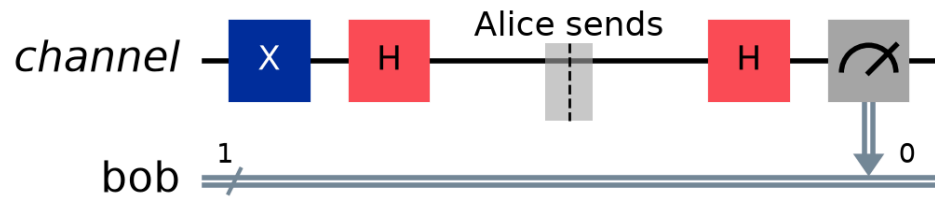
```
qc.ry(theta, psi)           # the state to send
qc.h(a); qc.cx(a, b)        # shared Bell pair
qc.cx(psi, a); qc.h(psi)    # Alice: reverse Bell circuit
qc.measure(psi, c[0]); qc.measure(a, c[1])
with qc.if_test((c[1], 1)): qc.x(b)    # Bob corrects
with qc.if_test((c[0], 1)): qc.z(b)
```

Verified in `teleportation.py`: $|0\rangle$, $|1\rangle$, $|+\rangle$ and $R_y(\pi/3)|0\rangle$ all arrive in 100% of shots.

BB84 — detecting an eavesdropper

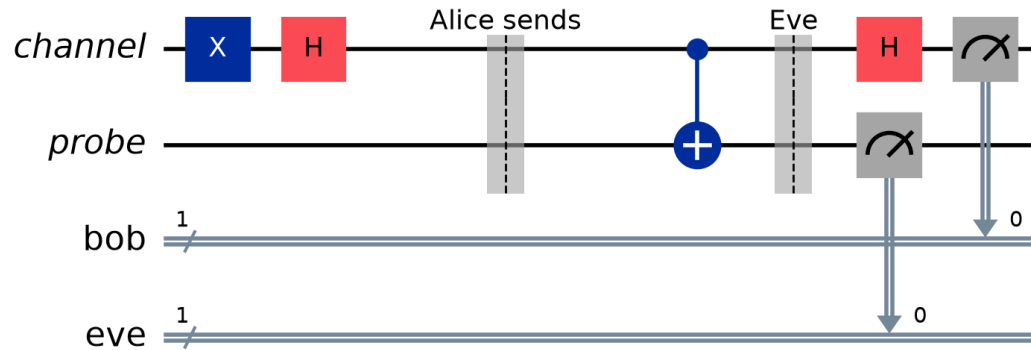
Not encryption. It produces a shared random key **and tells you if anyone looked**.

Two **conjugate** bases: $Z = \{|0\rangle, |1\rangle\}$ and $X = \{|+\rangle, |-\rangle\}$. Measuring in the wrong one gives a **coin flip** and destroys the state.



A clean round: Alice sends $|-\rangle$, Bob happens to pick X too, and reads her bit with certainty. One qubit per round — no entanglement anywhere.

BB84 — what Eve costs



Eve cannot copy the qubit (**no-cloning**), so she must measure — and guess a basis.

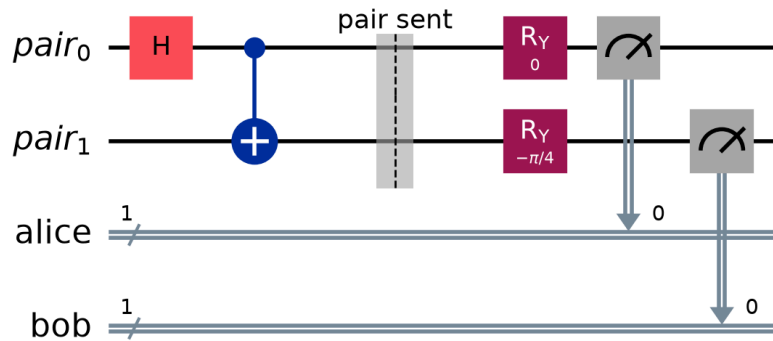
She is wrong half the time, and then Bob errs half of *those*:

$$\text{QBER} = \frac{1}{2} \times \frac{1}{2} = 25\%$$

Alice and Bob sacrifice some bits, compare them openly, and abort above **11%**.

Her gain: 75% of the key. Useless, because the key is discarded.

E91 — the same job, via Bell's theorem



A source emits entangled pairs. Each side measures along a randomly chosen axis.

$$E(\theta_a, \theta_b) = \cos(\theta_a - \theta_b)$$

Combine four settings into the **CHSH** sum S . Any theory where the bits existed before measurement obeys $|S| \leq 2$. Quantum mechanics reaches $2\sqrt{2} \approx 2.83$.

Eve has to entangle herself with the pair to learn anything — and **monogamy of entanglement** means that halves every correlation, dropping S to 1.41.

Measured: $S = 2.78 \pm 0.07$ clean, 1.34 with Eve. The eavesdropper is visible as a *failed violation*.

Recap

	sends	adversary	needs entanglement
Superdense coding	2 bits via 1 qubit	no	yes
Teleportation	1 qubit via 2 bits	no	yes
BB84	a secret key	yes	no
E91	a secret key	yes	yes

All four run locally or on IBM hardware with `--ibm` .

github.com/alessandrogpz/quantum-computing-notes